

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

The Knowledge Paralegal role in A&O Shearman's Global Financial Markets group interests me because it sits at the intersection of legal research, document work and a practice area I have been actively developing knowledge of through my LLM. My background in evidence review, legal research and structured document management across disputes and regulatory work gives me a practical foundation for the knowledge and research support the role involves.

At BCLP I supported a complex investment arbitration over six months, conducting legal research, drafting procedural histories and helping to maintain structured electronic case files across a matter with competing deadlines. Shortly before a significant submission deadline, I became the only junior supporting the team and coordinated outstanding documents and tracked actions to ensure on-time delivery. That experience gave me a clear sense of what it takes to keep a high-volume matter organised under pressure, and the research and drafting work I did there is directly transferable to supporting a knowledge function in a transactional practice.

During my LLM at Queen Mary I studied international arbitration and dispute resolution in depth, and my dissertation on the development of GDPR across jurisdictions was awarded a Distinction. More broadly, the programme gave me exposure to comparative legal analysis and cross-border regulatory frameworks, which I think is useful context for a team that works across practice groups and jurisdictions on financial markets transactions. At Q-Legal I also managed a data-privacy matter for a data-driven start-up from instruction through to a formal written advice letter, researching UK GDPR obligations and translating complex statutory requirements into commercially focused advice. That taught me how to handle legal research carefully and communicate it clearly to a non-specialist audience.

What draws me to a knowledge role specifically is the chance to build a detailed, structured understanding of a practice area rather than moving quickly between unrelated matters. Financial markets is an area I want to develop in, and a role that involves maintaining and developing legal know-how resources, tracking market practice and supporting lawyers across the group seems like a strong way to do that while contributing something concrete from day one.

I am based in the Reading area and available to travel to West Wickham.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva